not only aligns their interests with the company's success but also reflects their confidence and commitment, as evidenced by their decision to hold onto their shares. This blend of professional empowerment and personal investment is fundamental to Radico Khaitan's success.

- **Can you comment on how the drinking culture in India has evolved, particularly with the influence of younger generations and social media?**

The drinking culture in India has evolved significantly, especially with the advent of the internet and social media. Over the next decade, we anticipate this evolution to accelerate. Notably, drinking has become more acceptable among women and younger generations. What was once taboo, such as drinking with one's father, has become a norm. Today, parties not serving alcohol are an exception, indicating a shift towards more openness.

Responsible drinking is also becoming more prevalent. For example, Delhi has seen an exponential increase in pubs and bars. However, this growth has not led to an increase in negative incidents; on the contrary, they have come down, indicating a maturing drinking culture. The evolution of this culture is just beginning, and we expect it to continue developing in the coming years.

- **There are regulatory challenges around the industry. What has been your strategy for navigating these challenges?**

Our industry, both fortunately and unfortunately, is one of the largest contributors to state revenue. For instance, about seven years ago, Uttar Pradesh generated 14,000 crore INR from liquor. Today, that figure is 47,000 crore INR, accounting for 20% of the state's revenue. States are recognizing that if they manage the liquor industry well and make it more accessible, like Uttar Pradesh has, they can significantly boost their revenue to support state growth.

The acceptance of liquor is increasing, and the retailing culture is evolving. In the next five to ten years, we expect to see more changes similar to those in Gurgaon and Maharashtra, where retail spaces have become more consumer-friendly. Large, well-designed retail shops are making it comfortable for everyone, including women, to shop for their preferred products. This trend is set to continue, enhancing the overall shopping experience.

- **How did the COVID-19 pandemic alter the drinking culture and behavior, and how did you manage to navigate through those challenges?**

The COVID-19 pandemic has been a learning experience for everyone. It has taught us that life is unpredictable, and it's important to live and enjoy every moment. This shift in mindset has significantly changed marketing and consumption patterns. During the pandemic, people started drinking at home, getting accustomed to premium products. This behavior persisted even after restrictions eased, with many consumers continuing to prefer premium options when they go out.

As a result, the premium segment of our industry has seen substantial growth. Radico has experienced over 20% growth in premium products over the last four to five years. The pandemic has also influenced broader consumer behavior. People now prioritize experiences over material possessions. For example, the younger generation prefers spending on holidays rather than buying jewelry. This shift has benefited the luxury sector, including hotels and high-end car rentals, as people are more willing to invest in lifetime experiences.

- **What potential do you see for Indian brands in the global market?**

The potential for Indian brands in the global market is immense. Under the leadership of Prime Minister Modi, Indian brands have gained significant respect internationally. Let's take single malts as an example. Historically, the market was dominated by Scottish malts. However, we've seen the rise of Japanese malts, which are now highly sought after and command prices three to four times higher than their Scottish counterparts.

Similarly, the wine industry has seen a shift from traditional French wines to new-age wines from regions like America, Australia, and Chile. This trend is mirrored in the acceptance of Indian single malts like Rampur. There is a certain mysticism and allure associated with India, which adds to the appeal of our products.

In the past decade and a half, Indian manufacturers have significantly improved the quality of their products, ensuring they meet international standards without compromise. We charge a premium, but we ensure that our quality is top-notch. As India continues to rise as a global power, the acceptability and demand for Indian products on the international stage have grown substantially.

- **Under PM Modi's leadership, 'Make in India' has gathered steam. You yourself are a very successful example of the thrust on going local.**

'Make in India' has indeed been a transformative initiative, and we at Radico Khaitan are proud to embody the essence of this vision. Our journey exemplifies the core principles of 'Make in India'—innovation, quality, and global competitiveness. By focusing on premium and luxury products, we have not only captured the domestic market but have also established a strong presence internationally. This success demonstrates the potential of Indian brands to compete on the global stage, reflecting the broader aspirations of the 'Make in India' movement.

As per industry sources, the symbiosis between Abhishek Khaitan and Amar Sinha, is an exceptional combination, which has been adequately proven with the growth of Radico. Their shared vision & trust has been a driving force behind Radico Khaitan's outstanding growth trajectory.

- **Please acquaint us with your future plans.**

The future for Radico Khaitan looks incredibly promising, especially on the premium side. We see immense potential in white spirits, where Radico is already the market leader. There is significant opportunity in the malt sector, and our dominance in whisky remains strong. Recently, we launched Kohinoor, which is the most expensive rum from India, priced at around $50 to $60 a bottle. The response to this product has been fantastic. We are here to surprise the world. Our vision is to make Radico a strong global player with our existing & expanding footprint in over 100 countries.

- **What role do sustainability and ethical practices play in your future growth strategy?**

Sustainability and ethical practices are crucial to our future growth strategy. At Radico Khaitan, we have undertaken numerous initiatives in this regard. For instance, we collaborate with NGOs like Art of Living to improve water management, which has helped transform Uttar Pradesh's Rampur from a critical zone to a safe zone. Additionally, we are actively involved in women empowerment programs and other community activities. Internally, we focus on building robust processes and systems to ensure that the organization remains strong and resilient, regardless of individual changes. These efforts are integral to our vision of sustainable and ethical growth.